

- the picture description with the two compulsory questions is recommended to last **1.5 to 2 minutes** for 12 marks, and
- the broader conversation is recommended to last **3 to 3.5 minutes** for 16 marks.
- The total number of marks for Task 3 is 28 marks.

Higher tier assessment time and marks

The total assessment for the three tasks is **10 to 12 minutes plus 15 minutes' preparation time.**

The assessment is worth 50 marks.

The assessment consists of three tasks which must be conducted in the following order:

- Task 1 – one read aloud with short interaction to follow, recommended to last between **2 and 2.5 minutes** for 12 marks
- Task 2 – one role play, recommended to last **1 to 1.5 minutes** for 10 marks
- Task 3 – one picture task, recommended to last **7 to 8 minutes** in total
 - the picture description with the two compulsory questions is recommended to last **2 to 2.5 minutes** for 12 marks,

- the broader conversation is recommended to last **5 to 5.5 minutes** for 16 marks.
- The total number of marks for Task 3 is 28 marks.

Preparation time

Students are allocated 15 minutes' preparation time, under supervised conditions, immediately prior to the assessment.

The purpose of the 15 minutes preparation time is to consider the text for the read aloud and the allocated stimuli for the role play and picture task.

The final 1 minute of the preparation time should take place in the examination room, where students will be given the opportunity to practise the read aloud task out loud. It is not compulsory for the student to read the full task out loud during this minute. Students may use this time to practise selected words / phrases / sentences or the entire text out loud or undertake any other appropriate preparation. The 1-minute preparation will not be assessed but **must** form part of the continuous recording of the assessment submitted to Pearson. The purpose of recording the preparation time is to ensure that no guidance or correction is provided to the student during this time.

During the 15 minute preparation time, students are permitted to make notes on an A4 sheet of paper. In addition, they can directly annotate the text for the read aloud in order to aid pronunciation during the task.

During the assessment, students can refer to notes and annotations. The notes should be for reference only. Stimulus material for each task should be handed to the teacher at the end of the task (i.e. directly after the read aloud passage, but before the short interaction; directly after the roleplay; at the end of the picture description). At the end of the examination, students must also return their notes to the teacher.

Any notes made during the preparation time must be kept securely by the centre until the end of October in the year the assessment is completed, after which time they should be securely destroyed.

Students cannot have access to a dictionary, or any other resource, during the preparation time.

Sample assessment materials